AI Adoption Platform - Requirements Document

Executive Summary

A tiered SaaS platform helping small and medium businesses (SMBs) systematically plan and implement AI adoption strategies tailored to their industry, size, and technical maturity.

Target Audience

Primary Users: Business leaders at SMBs (10-500 employees)

- CEOs, Founders, Managing Directors
- Operations Directors
- Digital Transformation Leads
- Department Heads exploring AI opportunities

Key Characteristics:

- Limited AI expertise
- Budget-conscious
- Need practical, actionable guidance
- Value time efficiency
- Require ROI justification for initiatives

Product Tiers

Tier 1: Self-Service AI Readiness Platform

Price Point: $49-99/month or one-time $299

Core Features:

- **AI Readiness Assessment**
    - Interactive questionnaire covering:
        - Industry vertical

        - Current technology stack
        - Data maturity
        - Team technical skills
        - Budget parameters
        - Pain points and objectives
    - Generates personalized readiness score (0-100)
- **Customized AI Roadmap Generator**
    - Industry-specific recommendations
    - Prioritized quick wins vs. long-term initiatives
    - Estimated costs and timelines
    - Required resources and skills
    - Risk assessment
- **Use Case Library**
    - 100+ categorized AI use cases by:
        - Industry (retail, manufacturing, healthcare, professional services, etc.)
        - Department (sales, marketing, operations, customer service)
        - Complexity level (beginner, intermediate, advanced)
        - ROI potential
    - Each use case includes:
        - Problem statement
        - Solution overview
        - Implementation complexity
        - Typical costs
        - Success metrics
        - Real-world examples
- **Vendor Comparison Tool**
    - Database of AI tools and platforms
    - Filterable by use case, budget, integration requirements
    - Pros/cons analysis
    - Pricing transparency
- **Learning Resources**
    - Video tutorials (5-15 minutes each)
    - Downloadable templates (RFP templates, ROI calculators, project charters)
    - Glossary of AI terms
    - Best practices guides
- **Progress Tracking Dashboard**
    - Milestones and task management
    - Budget tracking
    - Success metrics monitoring

Tier 2: Guided AI Strategy Program

Price Point: $499-999/month or $3,000-6,000 package

Includes Tier 1 features plus:

- **1-on-1 Video Consultations**
  - 3-6 sessions (60 minutes each) with AI adoption specialists
  - Initial strategy session
  - Roadmap refinement meetings
  - Implementation checkpoint reviews
- **Custom AI Adoption Roadmap**
  - Professionally developed 12-18 month plan
  - Detailed implementation phases
  - Resource allocation recommendations
  - Change management strategy
  - Risk mitigation plan
- **Team Readiness Assessment**
  - Skills gap analysis
  - Training recommendations
  - Hiring profiles for AI-related roles
- **Vendor Selection Support**
  - Assisted RFP development
  - Vendor shortlisting
  - Evaluation criteria development
- **ROI Modeling**
  - Custom financial projections
  - Break-even analysis
  - Budget allocation recommendations
- **Monthly Check-in Calls**
  - 30-minute progress reviews
  - Ongoing guidance and troubleshooting
- **Priority Email Support**
  - Response within 24 hours
- **Community Access**
  - Private peer network
  - Monthly group Q&A sessions
  - Shared resources and case studies

Tier 3: Hands-On Implementation Partnership

Price Point: $5,000-15,000/month or custom project-based pricing

Includes Tier 1 & 2 features plus:

- **On-Site/In-Person Consulting**
  - Quarterly on-site visits (or more frequent as needed)
  - Executive workshops
  - Team training sessions

    - Stakeholder alignment meetings
- **Dedicated Account Manager**
    - Single point of contact
    - Weekly sync calls
    - Proactive guidance
- **Implementation Project Management**
    - End-to-end project oversight
    - Vendor management support
    - Timeline and milestone tracking
    - Issue escalation and resolution
- **Custom AI Proof of Concepts**
    - Assistance developing/running pilot projects
    - Data analysis support
    - Results measurement and reporting
- **Technical Advisory**
    - Architecture reviews
    - Integration planning
    - Data strategy development
    - Security and compliance guidance
- **Change Management Support**
    - Communication plan development
    - Training program design
    - Adoption metrics and monitoring
- **Executive Reporting**
    - Monthly progress reports
    - KPI dashboards
    - Board presentation materials
- **Priority 24/7 Support**
    - Dedicated Slack channel or similar
    - Emergency support availability

Core Functional Requirements

User Management

- Account creation with email verification
- SSO integration (Google, Microsoft)
- Role-based access control (Admin, Member, Viewer)
- Team/multi-user accounts for Tier 2 & 3
- User profile management
- Subscription management and billing

Assessment Engine

- Dynamic questionnaire with conditional logic
- Progress saving (auto-save every 30 seconds)
- Assessment history and comparison
- Re-assessment capability with change tracking
- Export assessment results (PDF, DOCX)

Recommendation Engine

- AI-powered matching algorithm considering:
    - Industry vertical
    - Company size
    - Technical maturity
    - Budget constraints
    - Stated objectives
- Prioritization logic (quick wins, strategic initiatives)
- Customizable roadmap templates
- Drag-and-drop roadmap editor

Content Management

- Use case library with rich media (videos, images, case studies)
- Searchable and filterable content
- User ratings and reviews
- Regular content updates
- Industry news and trends feed

Scheduling System (Tier 2 & 3)

- Integrated calendar booking (Calendly-style)
- Automated email reminders
- Video conferencing integration (Zoom, Teams, Google Meet)
- Rescheduling capabilities
- Session notes and recordings storage

Communication Tools

- In-app messaging
- Email notifications (customizable frequency)
- Video call functionality
- Document sharing and collaboration
- Comment threads on roadmap items

Reporting & Analytics

- User progress dashboards
- ROI calculator with editable assumptions
- Export capabilities (PDF, Excel)
- Custom report builder
- Data visualization (charts, graphs)

Payment Processing

- Secure payment gateway (Stripe recommended)
- Multiple payment methods (credit card, ACH)
- Subscription management
- Automatic billing
- Invoice generation
- Upgrade/downgrade flows

Technical Requirements

Platform Architecture

Recommended Technology Stack:

Frontend:

- **Framework:** React or Next.js
  - *Rationale:* Component-based architecture enables modular development, excellent for complex dashboards and interactive tools. Next.js adds SEO benefits and server-side rendering for marketing pages.
- **State Management:** Redux Toolkit or Zustand
  - *Rationale:* Necessary for managing complex application state across assessment flows, roadmaps, and user sessions.
- **UI Component Library:** Material-UI (MUI) or Tailwind CSS + Headless UI
  - *Rationale:* Accelerates development with pre-built, accessible components while maintaining professional appearance.
- **Charting Library:** Recharts or Chart.js
  - *Rationale:* Essential for dashboards and ROI visualization; these libraries offer good balance of features and performance.

Backend:

- **Runtime:** Node.js with Express or Next.js API routes

    - *Rationale:* JavaScript/TypeScript across stack reduces context switching, large ecosystem, excellent for real-time features.
    - *Alternative:* Python with Django/FastAPI if preference for data science integration.
- **Database:** PostgreSQL (primary), Redis (caching/sessions)
    - *Rationale:* PostgreSQL offers robust relational data management, JSONB for flexible document storage, excellent for complex queries. Redis provides fast session management and caching.
- **ORM:** Prisma (Node.js) or SQLAlchemy (Python)
    - *Rationale:* Type-safe database access, migrations management, developer productivity.

Authentication & Authorization:

- **Auth Service:** Auth0, Clerk, or Supabase Auth
    - *Rationale:* Battle-tested security, SSO support, reduces development time, compliance-ready (GDPR, SOC2).
- **Authorization:** Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) with permission-based rules
    - *Rationale:* Different tiers require different feature access; team accounts need granular permissions.

File Storage:

- **Service:** AWS S3, Cloudflare R2, or Google Cloud Storage
    - *Rationale:* Scalable, reliable, cost-effective for documents, videos, user uploads. CDN integration for fast delivery.

Video Infrastructure (Tier 2 & 3):

- **Video Calls:** Twilio Video API, Daily.co, or Zoom API
    - *Rationale:* Embedded video calling without leaving platform improves UX; recordings storage for future reference.
- **Video Hosting:** Vimeo Pro/Business or Mux
    - *Rationale:* Professional video delivery, adaptive streaming, analytics, DRM protection for premium content.

Email Service:

- **Provider:** SendGrid, AWS SES, or Resend
    - *Rationale:* Transactional email delivery, templates, analytics, high deliverability rates.
- **Email Sequences:** Customer.io or Brevo (formerly Sendinblue)
    - *Rationale:* Automated onboarding flows, nurture campaigns, triggered emails based on user behavior.

Payment Processing:

- **Gateway:** Stripe
    - *Rationale:* Industry standard, excellent API, subscription management built-in, global support, extensive documentation.

Scheduling:

- **Service:** Cal.com (self-hosted option) or Calendly API
    - *Rationale:* Professional booking experience, calendar integrations, timezone handling, automated reminders.

CMS for Content:

- **Headless CMS:** Sanity, Contentful, or Strapi
    - *Rationale:* Non-technical team members can update use cases, blog posts, resources without developer involvement. Structured content with version control.

Analytics:

- **Product Analytics:** Mixpanel or PostHog
    - *Rationale:* Track user behavior, funnel analysis, feature adoption, cohort analysis for product decisions.
- **Web Analytics:** Plausible or Google Analytics 4
    - *Rationale:* Marketing metrics, traffic sources, privacy-focused option with Plausible.

Hosting & Infrastructure:

- **Platform:** Vercel (Next.js apps), Railway, Render, or AWS ECS
    - *Rationale:* Modern deployment workflows, auto-scaling, built-in CI/CD, developer-friendly.
- **CDN:** Cloudflare or AWS CloudFront
    - *Rationale:* Global content delivery, DDoS protection, improved performance.

AI/ML Components

Recommendation System:

- **Approach:** Hybrid recommendation algorithm combining:
    - Content-based filtering (matching business attributes to use case features)
    - Collaborative filtering (learning from similar businesses' successful adoptions)
    - Rule-based business logic (hard constraints like budget, industry regulations)
- **Technology:** Python-based service (scikit-learn, pandas) with API exposure
    - *Rationale:* Python's data science ecosystem is mature; microservice architecture keeps it separate from main app for independent scaling.

NLP for Content Search:

- **Technology:** Elasticsearch or Algolia
    - *Rationale:* Semantic search across use cases, resources, vendor database. Algolia offers managed service with great UX; Elasticsearch provides more control.

Performance Requirements

- Page load time: < 2 seconds for initial load, < 500ms for navigation
- Assessment saving: Real-time with optimistic updates
- Support 10,000+ concurrent users (scale target)
- 99.9% uptime SLA for Tier 2 & 3 customers
- API response time: < 200ms for 95th percentile

Security Requirements

- SOC 2 Type II compliance (required for enterprise clients)
- GDPR and CCPA compliance
- Encryption at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3)
- Regular security audits and penetration testing
- Data backup and disaster recovery plan (RPO: 1 hour, RTO: 4 hours)
- Multi-factor authentication option
- Session management with automatic timeout
- Rate limiting and DDoS protection
- Input sanitization and SQL injection prevention
- Regular dependency updates and vulnerability scanning

Integration Requirements

- Calendar systems: Google Calendar, Outlook, iCal
- Video conferencing: Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Google Meet
- CRM integration (future): Salesforce, HubSpot
- Accounting software (future): QuickBooks, Xero
- SSO providers: Google Workspace, Microsoft Azure AD, Okta
- Webhooks for third-party integrations
- REST API for partners
- Slack/Teams notifications (Tier 3)

Mobile Considerations

- Responsive web design (mobile-first approach)
- Progressive Web App (PWA) capabilities
- Native mobile apps (Phase 2 consideration)
- Offline capability for assessment and content viewing

Non-Functional Requirements

Scalability

- Horizontal scaling capability
- Database sharding strategy for growth beyond 100K users
- Microservices architecture for independent component scaling
- CDN for static asset delivery
- Async job processing for heavy operations (report generation, AI recommendations)

Maintainability

- Comprehensive API documentation (OpenAPI/Swagger)
- Code documentation standards
- Automated testing (unit, integration, e2e)
- CI/CD pipeline with automated deployments
- Feature flags for gradual rollouts
- Logging and monitoring (Datadog, New Relic, or Sentry)

Accessibility

- WCAG 2.1 Level AA compliance
- Screen reader compatibility
- Keyboard navigation support
- Color contrast requirements
- Alt text for images
- Closed captions for videos

Localization (Future)

- Multi-language support infrastructure
- Currency conversion
- Regional compliance (GDPR, etc.)
- Localized content library

User Experience Requirements

Onboarding Flow

1. Sign-up with email or SSO (< 2 minutes)
2. Welcome video (30-60 seconds, skippable)
3. Quick profile setup (company name, industry, role)
4. Tier selection with feature comparison
5. Payment (for paid tiers)
6. Immediate value: Start assessment or browse use cases

Key User Journeys

Journey 1: New User Seeking Quick Wins (Tier 1)

1. Complete AI readiness assessment (10-15 minutes)
2. Receive personalized roadmap
3. Explore top 3 recommended use cases
4. Download implementation template
5. Track progress on dashboard

Journey 2: Business Leader Needs Strategic Guidance (Tier 2)

1. Complete assessment
2. Book first consultation call
3. Prepare for call with pre-meeting questionnaire
4. Attend consultation
5. Receive custom roadmap document
6. Schedule follow-up milestones
7. Monthly check-ins

Journey 3: Enterprise Client Full Implementation (Tier 3)

1. Initial discovery call
2. On-site assessment workshop
3. Detailed roadmap development
4. Weekly progress sync calls
5. Pilot project launch support
6. Executive reporting
7. Quarterly business reviews

Dashboard Design

- Overview metrics (readiness score, progress %, initiatives launched)
- Next action items (clear CTAs)
- Recent activity feed
- Upcoming meetings/milestones (Tier 2 & 3)
- Resource recommendations
- Quick access to support

Content Requirements

Initial Content Library (MVP)

- 20-30 detailed use cases across 5-6 industries
- 10 video tutorials
- 5 downloadable templates
- Comprehensive glossary (100+ terms)
- 3 industry-specific roadmap templates

Ongoing Content Strategy

- 2-4 new use cases monthly
- 1-2 new video tutorials monthly
- Quarterly industry trend reports
- Weekly blog posts (SEO strategy)
- Case study publication quarterly
- Vendor database updates monthly

Content Quality Standards

- All content reviewed by AI practitioners
- Real-world examples required
- Citations for statistics and claims
- Clear, jargon-free language (with definitions)
- Actionable takeaways in every piece

Metrics & KPIs

Product Metrics

- User activation rate (completed assessment)
- Feature adoption rate by tier
- Time to value (days until first "win")
- Monthly active users (MAU)
- Session duration and frequency
- Content engagement (views, downloads)
- Roadmap completion rate

Business Metrics

- Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)
- Lifetime Value (LTV)
- LTV:CAC ratio (target: > 3:1)
- Churn rate by tier (target: < 5% monthly)
- Upgrade rate (Tier 1 to 2, Tier 2 to 3)
- Net Promoter Score (target: > 50)
- Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)
- Customer satisfaction (CSAT) for consulting services

Success Metrics for Users

- AI initiatives launched
- ROI achieved (self-reported)
- Time saved in planning process
- Team confidence in AI strategy

Development Phases

Phase 1: MVP (3-4 months)

- Core Tier 1 functionality
- Assessment engine
- Basic recommendation system
- 20 use cases
- User authentication
- Payment integration
- Responsive web design

Phase 2: Enhanced Self-Service (2-3 months)

- Expanded use case library (50+)
- Vendor comparison tool
- Advanced roadmap customization
- Progress tracking dashboard
- Learning resources
- Community features (forums, Q&A)

Phase 3: Tier 2 Launch (2-3 months)

- Scheduling system

- Video consultation platform
- Custom roadmap generator
- Consultant management system
- Enhanced reporting

Phase 4: Tier 3 & Enterprise (3-4 months)

- Advanced project management tools
- Client collaboration workspace
- Document repository
- Executive reporting templates
- Mobile app (iOS, Android)
- API for integrations

Phase 5: AI Enhancement (Ongoing)

- Machine learning-powered recommendations
- Predictive analytics
- Chatbot assistant
- Automated content generation
- Personalized learning paths

Risk Considerations

Technical Risks

- **Scalability challenges:** Mitigate with cloud-native architecture, load testing
- **Data security breach:** Implement defense in depth, regular audits, insurance
- **Third-party service outages:** Multiple vendor redundancy, fallback options
- **AI recommendation accuracy:** Human oversight, feedback loops, continuous improvement

Business Risks

- **Low user adoption:** Strong onboarding, clear value proposition, user research
- **High churn:** Customer success program, proactive support, continuous value delivery
- **Competitive pressure:** Strong brand, proprietary content, superior UX
- **Consultant availability (Tier 3):** Scalable model, partner network, recorded resources

Compliance Risks

- **Data privacy regulations:** Legal review, compliance framework, regular audits

- **Industry-specific requirements:** Vertical-specific compliance features
- **AI ethics and bias:** Transparent algorithms, fairness audits, user controls

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Launch Strategy

Pre-Launch (2 months before)

- Beta testing with 20-30 target customers
- Content marketing (blog, LinkedIn, industry publications)
- Partnerships with business associations
- Waitlist building
- Pricing validation

Launch

- Soft launch to email list
- Product Hunt launch
- PR outreach to business and tech media
- Webinar series
- Limited-time founding member pricing

Post-Launch (First 90 days)

- Daily monitoring of KPIs
- Rapid iteration based on feedback
- Customer success outreach
- Case study development
- Referral program launch

Success Criteria

6 Months

- 500+ active users
- 50+ Tier 2 customers
- 5+ Tier 3 clients
- < 5% monthly churn
- NPS > 40
- Break-even on CAC within 12 months

12 Months

- 2,000+ active users
- 200+ Tier 2 customers
- 20+ Tier 3 clients
- Profitable (positive EBITDA)
- 100+ documented success stories
- Industry recognition (awards, features)

24 Months

- 10,000+ active users
- Market leader positioning
- International expansion
- Strategic partnerships with major tech vendors
- Potential acquisition interest or Series A funding